



Ask (the) Oracle

Ravi Pinto, Director - Product Management, Oracle Cloud Platform talks to Digit about Oracle's plans for Indian enterprises, and developers

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Q Is India primarily using the cloud as IaaS, PaaS or SaaS?

Pinto: India is one of the fastest growing cloud economies within APAC. Most companies have started to see beyond immediate cost savings and efficiency improvements; they acknowledge that cloud is a prerequisite for accelerating innovation and adding scalability and flexibility.

While cloud customers use a combination of services, most large enterprises begin their cloud journey with one solution such as HCM or ERP or both. We see a lot of startups using IaaS and PaaS together to build "Born in Cloud" applications.

Q Given the booming start-up scenario, do you see a shift towards a certain XaaS being the dominant model in the future?

Pinto: The beauty of cloud is that it's a great equalizer – a startup or a midsize company can use the same enterprise-grade technology as a large company. As a result of this, the "Anything-as-a-Service" (XaaS) business model is gaining popularity with startups as more and more end users are discovering lower price points, higher service value, and guaranteed QoS that cloud computing-based applications can deliver.

Q Containers vs Serverless? Which do you prefer and why?

Pinto: Even though containers greatly assist developers and admins in creating portable code, they still need to be managed. Serverless computing removes a lot of friction and run-time overhead from creating new applications, especially new cloud-native applications.

As the only global cloud company at scale, we provide both options to customers. There are some customers who want greater control on their application infrastructure and therefore, focus on containers; for such customers, we offer the Managed Kubernetes service, which enables them to manage containers at large scale. There are other customers who are focused more on running their apps and don't want the hassle of managing the infrastructure; such customers typically prefer our serverless offering.

Q Traditionally software companies have turned towards building hardware AI accelerators to cater to the increasingly popular workload. How is Oracle poised to compete in such a market?

Pinto: Oracle delivers a complete suite of business-critical, AI-enabled applications to help companies make better-informed decisions across enterprise operations. It also offers powerful AI-enabled platform services, such as management, security, and conversational chatbots.

Oracle is in a unique position to deliver AI across all cloud services, including embedded AI within business applications, AI services within Oracle's platform, and an AI development environment running on the high-performance compute and network infrastructure required for accelerated model training. The essence of AI is learning from an abundance of data and building models that work in a specific domain. A critical ingredient for accurate models is deep domain knowledge to interpret findings. Over many years, Oracle has gained a deep expertise in three broad areas: technology, business processes, and analytics. Oracle's cross-industry domain knowl-

edge in many facets of IT operations and ten global, industry-specific, operational and analytical business processes are the foundation of our AI solutions.

Q What is Oracle's role and play in the developer community?

Pinto: Oracle has a rich history of building platforms and developer-focused technologies that are loved and used by millions of developers around the globe. In continuation of our commitment to invest in the developer community, we bought Oracle Code to India and helped developers to learn how to build modern web, mobile, enterprise and cloud-native applications. It is a free event for developers to update themselves about the latest technologies, practices and trends.

Oracle provides a complete development platform to automate the software supply chain and enable developers to focus on their code, while the platform administers itself.

Oracle is strengthening its Open Source play and we contribute directly to several key Open Source projects – Kubernetes, Docker and Hyperledger Fabric to name a few.

In short, cloud has opened doors for chat bots, natural language processing, and AI, all of which will transform the path further for developers.

Q Studies have claimed that the average Indian IT graduate isn't up to the mark to take up software development roles. Does Oracle have a similar view?

Pinto: On the contrary, we actively recruit from Indian institutes. Once the new hires are on board, they contribute to all aspects of cloud development and operations. 